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1. Purpose

Human Resources (HR) policies serve several important purposes within NAT IT Services Pvt Ltd.

- These policies are a set of guidelines and rules that govern the behavior, actions, and decisions of employees and the organization.
- HR policies serve as a vital tool for organizations to ensure legal compliance, foster a positive workplace culture, communicate expectations, and manage various aspects of the employer-employee relationship.
- They contribute to the smooth functioning of the organization and support the well-being of both employees and the organization.

2. Scope

The scope of this policy applies to all employees and contractors', consultants, temporary, and full time resources working in NAT IT Services in India. The applicable policies shall be mentioned in the respective contracts/offer letter determined by the nature of the engagement.

3. Responsibility Matrix

Roles	Responsibility	Accountability	Consulted	Informed
HR Lead	√			
Finance Head			√	√
Global Operations Head		√		
Employees				√

4. Description

In drafting this manual, Nat IT Services HR Function has avoided the use of specific gender pronouns wherever possible. However, where such avoidance would have led to very awkward sentences, we have used the masculine pronoun. This use should be considered to refer to all genders. HR Function shall ensure that the HR Policies are documented, communicated and made available to employees.

This Employee Handbook supersedes all previous Company handbooks and policies. In addition, this handbook supersedes all prior management memos to the extent that such memo contradicts a subject or policy covered therein.

Change in Policy:

The policies in this Manual are subject to change at the sole discretion of the Management and Leadership team. HR will notify all employees of these changes by appropriate means. Changes will be effective on

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dates determined by the Management, and Employees may not rely on policies that have been superseded. No supervisor or manager has any authority to alter the foregoing.

4.1 Employment Contracts

In recognition of the pivotal role employment contracts play in shaping the relationship between employers and employees, our organization is committed to establishing a robust Employment Contract Policy. This policy aims to ensure fairness, clarity, and legal compliance in all aspects of employment contracts within our company.

Nat IT Services is committed to fair, transparent, and legally compliant employment contracts. HR Head shall ensure that documented procedures are available and that all employment contracts are executed on the below principles:

- **Fairness:** Contracts will be fair, considering job roles, skills, and industry standards. Discrimination is prohibited.
- **Clarity:** Contracts will be clear, ensuring both parties understand rights, responsibilities, and benefits.
- **Legal Compliance:** Contracts will comply with all relevant labor laws and regulations.
- **Mutual Agreement:** Contracts will be based on mutual consent, with room for negotiation and written documentation of any changes.
- **Confidentiality:** Contracts may include clauses for protecting company information and intellectual property.
- **Dispute Resolution:** Procedures for resolving disputes will be outlined, emphasizing mediation or arbitration.
- **Implementation:** HR will oversee contract drafting, training on policy, and regular reviews.
- **Compliance:** Non-compliance may lead to disciplinary action.

The organization relies upon the accuracy of information contained in the employment application and the accuracy of other data presented throughout the hiring process and employment as provided by the candidate. Any misrepresentations, falsifications, or material omissions in any of this information or data may result in exclusion of the individual from further consideration for employment or, if the person has been hired, termination of employment.

4.2 Code of Conduct

Nat IT Services upholds high ethical standards outlined in the Code of Conduct Policy.

All employees are required to sign the Nat IT Services' code of conduct as a pre-condition of employment. (Please refer to NS/HR/PR/02_ Code of Business Conduct, Ethics, Harassment and Abuse Policy)

4.3 Employee Compensation -Salary

Managing employee payroll is a crucial aspect of legal compliance. The HR Function shall ensure that a documented procedure exists to ensure:

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- Appropriate wages have been identified for every role in line with Indian Labour laws, market norms and minimum wages for every role.
- Payment frequency for employees have been identified and defined in the employee contract.
- Standard deductions like advance (Income tax, professional tax, provident fund e.tc. shall be defined and mentioned in the employee contract.

4.4 Gratuity Policy

Nat IT Services pays employees Gratuity as per The Payment of Gratuity Act of 1972. An employee must have completed five continuous years of service to be eligible, with certain exceptions for periods of absence due to strikes, lockouts, accidents, long leaves, layoffs, unauthorized absence, or termination initiated by the employer.

4.5 Employee Provident Fund

Employee Provident Fund (EPF) is a significant social security scheme in India that aims to provide financial security and retirement benefits to employees. As an employer, Nat IT Services understands that EPF compliance is crucial to ensure legal adherence and employee welfare. EPF compliance is governed by the Employees' Provident Fund Scheme, 1952, and the Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952.

HR head must ensure to enroll eligible employees within the specified timeframe.

4.6 Leave Policy

Nat It Services recognizes the need for leaves. Leaves are granted to employees with the intention of providing rest, recuperation of health and fulfilling personal and social obligations. Taking enough rest and personal care is necessary to maintain high work productivity.

The HR function shall maintain a documented procedure on the rules and working practices of the business, pertaining to the below mentioned types of leaves which employees are eligible for.

Types of Leaves

The types of leaves applicable in the organization are:

1. Sick Leave (SL)
2. Earned Leave (EL)
3. Compensatory Leave (COMP OFF)
4. Maternity Leave (ML)
5. Paternity Leave (PL)
6. Leave without Pay (LWP)

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4.7 Sexual Harassment in The Workplace Policy—Posh Policy

Nat IT Services is committed to providing a work environment that ensures every employee is treated with dignity and respect and afforded equitable treatment. The organization is also committed to promoting a work environment that is conducive to the professional growth of its employees and encourages equality of opportunity.

The Organization will not tolerate any form of sexual harassment and is committed to take all necessary steps to ensure that its employees are not subjected to any form of harassment.

A detailed POSH (Prevention of sexual harassment) can be referred to at NIS/HR/PO/03)

4.8 Termination of Employment Policy

Nat IT Services is committed to handle all cases of termination of employment as dictated by law with discretion, professionalism, and official documentation. The organization recognizes the fact that it is beneficial for all parties that the employment separation process be as clear as possible so that misunderstandings and distrust between the employee and the company can be avoided.

- The HR function must have documented procedures and conditions under which an employee's association with the company ends. It must address both voluntary and involuntary dismissals, detailing reasons, processes, and legal considerations to ensure fairness and compliance during the separation process.
- The HR head will observe all legal dictations referring to termination/separation of employment and will avoid "implied contracts" and unnecessary terminations.
- Nat IT Services expects all employees with the right of terminating subordinates to strictly refrain from discharging someone without adequate reason or without giving notice.

4.9 Nondiscrimination Policy

Nat IT Services is an equal opportunity employer and is committed to providing equal employment opportunities to all individuals, regardless of their race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, sexual orientation, gender identity, or any other protected characteristic as defined by applicable law.

Discrimination in any form is strictly prohibited. Retaliation against any individual who reports discrimination participates in an investigation, or opposes discriminatory practices is strictly prohibited. Reporting discrimination or participating in an investigation will not adversely affect an individual's employment status or opportunities within the organization.

The HR Head shall ensure to :

- Effectively communicate the policy to all the employees.
- Promptly handle of all types of complaints under guidelines.

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- Introduce the latest changes in the policy and constantly reassess it to make it effective.

4.10 Dress Code Policy

Nat It services requires that employees dress neatly and appropriately at all times and that they maintain adequate personal hygiene. The success of any company is reliant on the support and goodwill of its customers. For this reason, it is important that Nat IT Services maintains a professional image. As representatives of this company, employees must adhere to the dress code policy.

The organization urges employees to use common sense and sound judgment when it comes to selecting their work attire. When in doubt, defer to the conservative and formal side.

HR function shall maintain a documented set of guidelines to help employees make the appropriate choice.

4.11. Probation and Confirmation Policy

Nat IT Services mandates that the probation period be specified in the offer letter and the appointment letter issued to all new hires.

The probationary process is underpinned by effectiveness, equity, and accountability. It is essential that the reporting managers should provide timely feedback to the newly hired employees on their performance.

HR function must have a documented framework of the Probation and confirmation Policy. This framework of probation policy includes various stages and verification processes. The new employee, reporting manager, and the HR department are part of the probationary process.



Fig: - The Framework of Probation Policy

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4.12. Work from Home Policy

Nat IT Services recognizes the potential benefits that flexible working arrangements (“Working from Home”) will have for specific employees and supports a hybrid combo of remote and in-office work where it can be demonstrated to provide benefits both to the organization and the individual.

- Nat IT Services considers “Working from Home” to be a viable and flexible option when both the employee and the job are a match for the arrangement.
- Employees may qualify for remote work if their job roles are compatible with working from home and compliant with the applicable laws and regulations.
- Managers will assess and approve remote work requests on a case-by-case basis, based on the specific requirements of the department involved and the needs of the team and the company.
- Remote employees play a vital role in maintaining the security and privacy of the company’s confidential or sensitive information. Employees working from home must follow established data security guidelines .
- All confidential or sensitive data must be handled via secure and approved methods, and any suspected security threats or data breaches must be reported to the IT department immediately.
- Staying compliant with all relevant labor laws, tax regulations and other legal requirements is a top priority for our remote work policy. Because remote employees may be located in a variety of legal jurisdictions, we are committed to adapting our policy as necessary to ensure compliance with any relevant local laws and regulations.
- Remote employees are expected to abide by the legal and regulatory requirements applicable in their jurisdictions and should reach out to the HR department if they have any compliance questions or concerns.
- Remote employees are required to maintain a consistent work schedule that aligns with their team’s needs and the company’s core working hours of
- All employees must be available and responsive during these core hours.

4.13 Grievance Policy

Nat IT Services aims to create a working environment in which all employees can freely raise concerns relating to their employment and seek a resolution promptly, fairly, and informally wherever possible. Where informal resolution is not possible, the grievance procedure exists to provide a means to achieve formal resolution. The emphasis of this policy is on problem solving and mediation rather than confrontation or an adversarial process.

The HR Function shall establish a formal grievance handling procedure, to provide a safe environment for the employees to raise their concerns. The Grievance policy holds the process by which the employees can report such complications in order to receive a proper solution.

For the purpose of the policy, Grievances means individual grievance and includes all matters but excludes the following:

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- Those already covered under Code of Conduct Policy, POSH Policy, Maternity Benefits Policy, and Employee Performance Appraisal .
- Grievance pertaining to, or arising out of, disciplinary action or appeal against such actions.
- Grievance arising out of termination/dismissal.

4.14. Awards and Recognition Policy

Reward and recognition play a major role in attracting and retaining talent within the organization.

Nat IT Services recognizes the accomplishments made by its employees. It is committed to honoring and encouraging individuals and teams who contribute through their efforts and actions to the success of the organization. Recognition may involve:

- Giving praise.
- Granting awards; and
- Celebrating and communicating successes.

Recognition will be linked to Nat IT Services corporate objectives by supporting defined goals and values. It will focus on creating an enduring effect for employees and the organization.

The HR Function must have a structured approach to recognizing and rewarding employees, ensuring consistency and fairness across the organization. By providing clear guidelines and criteria, HR professionals can seamlessly implement and manage recognition programs, fostering a positive work culture and boosting employee morale.

4.15. Drug and Alcohol Policy

Nat IT Services is dedicated to maintaining a drug-free workplace across all its offices across the globe. All employees are required to perform their job duties unimpaired by illegal drugs, marijuana, alcohol, or the improper use of legal substances. Employees are prohibited from working or reporting to work when impaired by alcohol or drugs.

Important: Employees are expected to take accountability for their actions and decisions. Any employee who is unfit to work because of alcohol or drug use may be sent home and this can result in corrective action, which may include termination of employment.

There is absolutely no tolerance for illegal drugs — or the solicitation, distribution, or misuse of legal drugs.

4.16 Performance Management and Appraisal Policy

It is the policy of Nat IT Services to provide an annual performance appraisal system that

- identifies performance goals necessary to achieve the organization's mission.
- evaluates employees' accomplishments toward these goals.

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The HR head is responsible for providing guidelines to managers and employees alike on how to effectively conduct and participate in the performance appraisal process.

The performance management process is based on the following principles:

- I. Performance appraisals will always be made on merit, to avoid discrimination and unfairness.
- II. All employees will be provided with information so that they understand these procedures and follow them to ensure the fair conduct of the performance appraisal process.
- III. Employees have the right to understand their performance expectations and the responsibilities are assigned to them.
- IV. Every employee has a right to ask for feedback on their performance at any time.

The HR Head has the right to change, modify or approve exceptions to this policy at any time with or without notice.

4.17 . Recruitment and Hiring Policy

Nat IT Services is committed to operating a fair, consistent and transparent process.

The purpose of this policy is to set out the approach the organization will take in order to ensure that the most suitable candidates with the relevant skills, experiences, competencies, attitudes and potential are appointed to posts through a fair, objective, robust and transparent recruitment procedure.

This policy shall serve as a catalyst in the Organization's talent-hiring efforts and initiatives by explicitly stating the procedures to be followed during the recruitment and hiring process. The policy aims to speed up decision-making by laying down guidelines and expectations for hiring the right talent.

This recruitment policy applies to all employees who are involved in hiring for our company. It refers to all potential job candidates.

4.18 Office Working Hours Policy

This policy aims to promote a consistent and productive work environment for all employees, while also ensuring that employees have a healthy work-life balance.

To ensure productivity, teamwork and the wellbeing of its employees a comprehensive guideline has been defined as below:

- NAT IT works on a 5-day schedule, Monday to Friday except for Holidays.
- Employees can take lunch/dinner breaks during office hours.
- Employees should be prepared to work on any shift, as may be warranted by the organization or its clients to meet business requirements from time to time.
- Depending on organizational requirement or project the work timings and days may be modified/ altered from time to time.
- Employees' minimum working hours are nine hours per day, including lunch/dinner break.

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- NAT IT Services expects its employees to be responsible and punctual while reporting to work .
The HR personnel must ensure that the policy guidelines are effectively communicated to all employees.

4.19 Attendance Policy

Employees at Nat It Services are expected to be present for work, on time, every workday. Regular attendance and punctuality are important to keep the team and the organization running smoothly. Arriving late, being tardy, or absent from work causes disruptions and burdens colleagues.

This policy mandates that documented procedures and guidelines are in place that tells employees exactly how various issues such as tardiness, no shows, early outs, no call-no shows, and different types of leaves will be handled.

4.20 Training and Development Policy

Nat IT Services believes in the need to develop all permanent and temporary employees, whether employed on a full-time or part-time basis.

There must be documented procedures and guidelines:

- for all process-related, mandatory training, technical skills, soft skills, and behavioral learning programs, adequately custom-designed for the organization.
- For the L&D team to assess & nominate resources such as trainers, budget, place and time.
- For conducting L&D programs, developed as a sequel to the appraisal recommendations or purely for business support requirements. This policy template is available for download in Word format.

4.21 Disciplinary Action Policy

Disciplinary procedures are necessary so that employees who breach the rules of conduct expected by the organization are treated reasonably, consistently, objectively and fairly in every case. The management at Nat It Services shall identify and standardize procedures for responding to incidents that go against company policies.

Disciplinary action is a corrective measure taken in response to an employee's misconduct, rule violation or poor performance. Disciplinary actions can vary depending on an infraction's severity. The following forms of disciplinary measures have been identified and the HR function shall define the criteria and procedures to initiate them.

- Verbal warning
- Written warning
- Probation
- Termination of employment

In deciding which initial corrective action would be appropriate, the Departmental Manager will consider the seriousness of the infraction, the circumstances surrounding the matter, and the Employee's previous record.

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4.22 Exit Policy

Nat IT Services believes in promoting better communication between the organization and employee, helping to ensure a positive transition for them both. It also sets the stage for a respectful and dignified departure, which can leave a lasting impression on the employee, while positively influencing the overall image and reputation of the organization.

HR function must have:

- procedures and guidelines for managing the departure of employees from an organization. It should cover various aspects of the exit process and ensures a smooth transition for both the departing employee and the organization.
- detail insight into the release formalities, the notice period required to be served, treatment of benefits, exit interview procedures, etc.
- ensure that the employee signs a confidentiality and non-disparagement agreement as a condition of receiving any severance pay or other benefits. The agreement prohibits the employee from disclosing confidential information or making negative comments about the company or its employees.
- ensure that the relevant departments have provided the go ahead to release the employee
- ensure from the concerned department head/immediate supervisor that the employee has returned all confidential information in their possession, including any copies or reproductions to the organization or certify in writing that such information has been destroyed.
- take all necessary steps to ensure that the employee does not pose a security risk or have access to any sensitive information.
- The Exit Policy should be communicated to all employees and made available to new employees upon hire.
- controls in place to ensure that all terminations are handled in compliance with applicable laws and regulations.

4.23 Re-Imbursement Policy

It is Nat IT Services' policy to Reimburse reasonable employee out-of-pocket expenses incurred in connection with travel and other business on behalf of the organization.

- If the expenses are travel-related, then refer to the travel policy.
- Expenses that are work related must be reported in a timely manner.
- All claimed Reimbursements must be substantiated by a receipt with the exception of minor expenses for which a receipt may not be available.
- Employees must document the business purpose for each expense item. Employees will seek Reimbursement only for reasonable and necessary expenses actually incurred for a valid business purpose.
- The employee offer letter must detail the type and amount of reimbursements the employee is entitled to.

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The Finance Department is responsible for the administration of this Policy. Any employee who violates this Policy or who abuses this Policy, for example by submitting fraudulent Reimbursement requests, will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

4.24 Confidentiality Policy

The purpose of this policy is to ensure the protection of confidential and proprietary information belonging to Nat It Services, its clients, and its business partners. This policy applies to all employees, contractors, consultants, temporary, and other workers at the company, including all personnel affiliated with third parties.

Confidential information includes any information which is not publicly known. It can concern technology, business, finance, transaction or other affairs of Nat IT Services as an organization.

The protection of confidential business information and trade secrets is vital to the interests and success of the organization. Such confidential information includes, but is not limited to, the following examples:

- any document, discovery, invention, patent specification, formulations, plans, ideas, books, accounts, data, reports, drafts of documents of all kinds, correspondence, client information, lists and files, decisions, information about employees, strategies, drawings, recommendations, designs, office precedents, policies and procedures, budget and financial information in any form, i.e. physical, electronic, electromagnetic or otherwise.
- Compensation data, financial information, Marketing strategies, pending projects and proposals, Personnel/Payroll records, and Conversations between any persons associated with the Company.

Responsibilities of Employees

Employees are expected to:

- Understand and adhere to this confidentiality policy.
- Refrain from disclosing confidential information to unauthorized persons.
- Use confidential information solely for the purpose for which it was intended.
- Securely store and dispose of confidential information.
- Immediately report any suspected or actual breach of confidentiality.

Handling Confidential Information

- Access Control: Access to confidential information is restricted to those who need it to perform their job duties.
- Non-Disclosure: Employees must sign a non-disclosure agreement (NDA) as a condition of employment.
- Communication: Confidential information should not be discussed in public places or shared via unsecured communication channels.

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- Data Protection: Use strong passwords, encryption, and secure methods to store and transfer confidential information.

Third-Party Disclosure

Confidential information should not be disclosed to third parties unless:

- There is a clear business need.
- The third party has signed an NDA.
- Approval has been obtained from a relevant authority within the company.

All employees must sign an acknowledgment form confirming they have read, understood, and agree to comply with this confidentiality policy.

Any Employee who improperly use or disclose trade secrets or confidential business information will be subjected to disciplinary action, including termination of employment and legal action, even if he/she does not actually benefit from the disclosed information.

4.25 Moonlighting Policy

Nat IT Services does not allow employees to take up work for another employer, including while they are serving their notice period for their existing employer. HR function must ensure to have this clause in the offer letter and sensitize the employee of the consequences of violating the policy.

Violations and Penalties:

Violations of the HR Policies could result in disciplinary action leading up to and including termination of employment and civil and/or criminal prosecution under federal and/or state laws.

Monitoring and Enforcement:

Regular monitoring and enforcement mechanisms should be in place to ensure that the HR Policy is being followed consistently across the organization. This may include conducting audits, reviews, and compliance checks and establishing consequences for non-compliance.

5. Exception(s)

Any exception to the above policies will require Approval from the HR Head.

6. Exclusion(s)

None

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7. Metrics

None

8. Records

None

9. Stakeholders Analysis

SL. No	Interested Party	Needs (N) & Expectations(E)	Risk Level	Addressed in Section
1	Employees	Employee Policies(E)	Low	Sec 4.0
2	Department Heads	Changes to the policy(N)	Low	Sec 4.0
3	HR Function	HR Policies are documented, communicated, and made available to employees(N)	Low	Sec 4.0
4	Management and Leadership Team	Policy Changes or New Policy roll out (N)	Low	Sec 4.0
5	Customers and Third party	Confidentiality Policy (E)	Low	Sec 4.24

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3x3 Risk Matrix			
Likelihood/Impact	Low Impact (1)	Moderate Impact (2)	High Impact (3)
Unlikely (1)	Low Risk (1)		
Likely (2)		Moderate Risk (4)	
Highly Likely (3)			High Risk (9)

10. Annexure

10.1 Terms and Definitions

None

10.2 References

- Telangana Shops and Establishment Act 1988,
- The Payment of Gratuity Act 1972
- The Employees Provident Funds and Miscellaneous provisions Act 1952
- The Employees State Insurance Act 1948
- Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023
- HR SOP
- Prevention of sexual harassment _ NIS/HR/PO/03
- Code of Business Conduct, Ethics, Harassment and Abuse Policy_ NS/HR/PR/02

10.3 ISO Clauses

4.1, 7.5,